

A BANKRUPT OSCAR SCHINDLER ABANDONED HIS WIFE AFTER WORLD WAR 2
THE REASON WHY OSCAR SCHINDLER'S WIFE EMILIE WAS NOT MENTIONED IN THE MOVIE

AFTER THE WAR THEY BOTH TRAVELED TO ARGENTINA IN 1949. IN 1957 OSCAR RETURNED TO GERMANY BY HIMSELF AND NEVER RETURNED TO ARGENTINA NOR DID HIS WIFE EMILIE

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WAR HISTORY ONLINE

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Steven Spielberg's Schindler's List (1993) centers around Oskar Schindler, a man who saved over 1,000 Jewish individuals during the Holocaust. While the film briefly mentions his wife, Emilie, it doesn't delve into her life following World War II. **It's surprising to discover, then, that a bankrupt Schindler abandoned his life partner after they fled to Argentina.**

MOVING TO ARGENTINA FOLLOWING WW2



After the Second World War, Oskar and Emilie Schindler lived in Regensburg, Germany. In 1949, they immigrated to Argentina, settling in Buenos Aires. Supported financially by a Jewish organization in the country, **they worked as chicken farmers.**

Emilie, who'd grown up in a small farming community in Czechoslovakia, quickly adapted to the rural lifestyle. According to her memoir, *When Light and Shadow Meet*, the same couldn't be said for her partner.

"I could never count on help from Oskar, who seemed more interested in the adventures the capital could provide," she wrote.

As such, for nearly eight years, she ran their poultry farm almost entirely on her own, without her husband's assistance.

OSCAR SCHINDLER ABANDONED HIS WIFE IN ARGENTINA



OSCAR SCHINDLER 1957

In 1957, Oskar Schindler left Argentina for Germany, never returning. Emilie remained.

He returned because the German government had enacted a law providing reparations to victims of World War II who'd suffered the loss of property, capital, or profession during the conflict. Schindler hoped to receive financial compensation for his business losses and promised Emilie he'd return to South America once the financial arrangements were completed.

However, Schindler never went back to Argentina, or to his wife. ***He ultimately remained in Germany, dying penniless and almost completely unknown in October 1974.*** He is buried on Mount Zion in Jerusalem, ***the only member of the Nazi party Israel has allowed to receive such an honor, and has a tree planted in his name at Yad Vashem's Avenue of the Righteous.***

EMILIE SCHINDLER NEVER DIVORCED HER HUSBAND

Despite Oskar Schindler not returning to Argentina or seeing Emilie again, the couple never officially divorced. The latter often considered divorcing her husband, to escape his "lies, his repeated deceits, and constant insincere repenting." ***Despite this, they remained separated for the rest of their lives.***

Following the release of *Schindler's List*, Emilie told a German reporter that her ***wedding ring was good insurance against the claims of his many mistresses.*** ***She never received a penny from the movie.***

EMILIE'S FINANCIAL STRUGGLES



Emilie Schindler, 1993

Emilie Schindler faced significant financial struggles after Oskar's move to Germany. According to her biography, she was unable to afford to pay her farm workers and barely had enough to feed herself. She recalled her meals primarily consisted of "tangerines I picked in the orchard, some bread, and lots of coffee to keep me awake."

Fortunately, in 1963, Emilie began receiving a small pension from Israel and Germany, which allowed her to support herself until her death.



Schindler's List, 1993.

In 1993, Emilie traveled to Israel for the epilogue of *Schindler's List*. In it, she, along with many of the Jewish people she and her husband had saved during the Second World War, visited Oskar Schindler's grave. *This was the only time she ever visited it.*

Emilie recalled that, during her visit, she silently said to him, "Well Oskar, at last, we meet again... I have received no answer, my dear. I do not know why you have abandoned me... [but] I have forgiven you everything."

Emilie ultimately appreciated *Schindler's List*, calling it "an excellent film that deserves all the awards it has received." *Her only criticism was that the film didn't fully capture the extent of her husband's womanizing, as she experienced it.*

RECOGNIZED FOR HER WORK DURING WW2



Emilie Schindler 1993

In 1993, Yad Vashem awarded Oskar and Emilie Schindler the title of Righteous Among the Nations, in recognition of their efforts during the Holocaust. Emilie's memoir suggests that she played a more significant role in saving Europe's Jewish population than is commonly understood. In a 1999 interview, she said, "Oskar is a hero. And what about me? I saved many Jews too."

Her memoir also portrays her husband as both a womanizer and as self-serving as he was generous.

In July 2001, Emilie returned to Germany, expressing a desire to spend her remaining days in her homeland, as she'd become increasingly homesick. She passed away on October 5, 2001, in Berlin, from the effects of a stroke. While Oskar Schindler is a significant figure from the Holocaust, Emilie's contributions were equally important, and her legacy deserves recognition.

PLEASE TAKE THE TIME TO READ THE NEXT COUPLE OF PAGES. THEY DEAL WITH A MISUNDERSTANDING BY STEVEN SPIELBURG DURING THE PRODUCTION OF THE MOVIE "SCHINDLER'S LIST" AND POSSIBLY PRESENTS THE REASON WHY OSCAR SCHINDLER'S WIFE EMILIE WAS NEVER MENTIONED IN THE FILM.



STEVEN SPIELBERG MISTOOK OSKAR SCHINDLER'S WIFE FOR A JEW SHE HAD SAVED
THE FILMMAKER ANGERED EMILIE SCHLINDER WITH A 1993 LETTER INVITING HER AND HER "SPOUSE" TO
'SCHLINDERS LIST' EPILOGUE



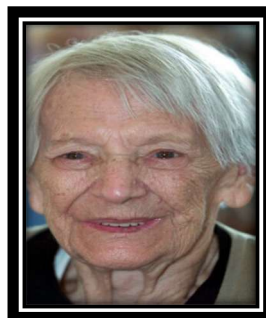
SOURCE

While US filmmaker Steven Spielberg was creating "Schindler's List," he mistook Emilie Schindler — who together with her husband, Oskar, saved some 1,200 Jews in the Holocaust — for a Jew she saved, newly published documents reveal.

In a bureaucratic faux pas, Spielberg sent a hand-signed letter to Schindler in 1993 inviting her to participate in the movie's epilogue as a Jew saved from death camps, even inviting her spouse to take part in the scene, British media reported Monday. **(See copy of this letter below)**

In later interviews, Schindler expressed her anger at the letter, as well as at being sidelined in the film and other historical accounts, which attribute the rescue of Jews solely to her husband. She did however accept Spielberg's invitation to the epilogue.

Emilie Schindler died in 2001. Her friend and biographer, Erika Rosenberg, says Oskar and Emilie had a "50-50" role in saving the Jews during the Holocaust by bribing Nazi officials to secure their freedom.



STEVEN SPIELBERG

May 7, 1993

Mrs. Emilie Schindler

Dear Mrs. Schindler:

You are part of a remarkable story. I first read about Oskar Schindler's improbable rescue of you and more than 1,300 other Jews from the threat of Nazi death camps more than ten years ago, and it has taken me until now to bring this important piece of history to the screen.

I am currently in Krakow, Poland, where I am filming *Schindler's List*, based on the novel by Thomas Keneally. The story of how your lives were saved will be shared with people all over the world as a major motion picture by the end of this year.

But *Schindler's List* is not merely an overview of an event in history. It is a story about people, as relevant now as it was when it happened fifty years ago. In making this film, it has been very important to me to emphasize *names* and *faces*, not just dates and places. Which brings me to the reason I am writing to you. I will be traveling to Israel with my crew to film an epilogue scene at Oskar Schindler's grave site. I would be deeply honored if you would appear in the scene and allow me to include your important face in the film.

You and your spouse are invited to come to Jerusalem as my guests May 25-May 30, 1993. We will host a special reunion reception for all Schindler Jews in attendance on May 27, and film at the grave site on May 28. A coordinator from my office will contact you with further details and travel arrangements.

I hope you can join me in Jerusalem to be part of this important message of peace for the world; the reminder that "He who saves a single life, saves the world entire," a tribute to a time that must never be forgotten. I look forward to seeing you.

All my best,


Steven Spielberg

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